

Critical Systems Recovery Priority Matrix

Ardent ISD | Business Continuity Planning

Purpose

This matrix gives district leaders a common view of which systems are most critical to restore and what they depend on. Specific technical recovery procedures, credentials, configurations, and sensitive security details belong in restricted operational documentation.

Service / Function	Priority	Business Impact if Unavailable	Key Dependencies	Business Owner
Identity / SSO	1	Users cannot access multiple district systems	Directory services, internet/WAN, MFA, DNS	Technology
Internet / WAN	1	Instruction, cloud applications, communications, and many operations disrupted	ISP circuits, routing, switching, power	Technology
Finance / Payroll	1	Payroll and financial operations may be delayed	Identity, servers/cloud service, banking interfaces	Finance
Student Information System	1	Attendance, enrollment, grades, scheduling, records access disrupted	Identity, internet/WAN, vendor service	Student Services
VoIP / Core communications	1	Internal/external calling and operational coordination affected	Network, power, carrier/SIP services	Operations
Transportation systems	2	Routing, dispatch, and family communication degraded	Internet/WAN, vendor platform, identity	Transportation
Learning Management System	2	Instructional continuity reduced	Internet, identity, vendor platform	Curriculum
MDM	2	Device management and deployment functions impaired	Internet, identity, vendor platform	Technology
Content filtering	2	Internet access governance/safety controls affected	Internet, DNS/network path, vendor service	Technology
Document management	3	Administrative workflows slowed	Identity, storage/vendor platform	Business Services

Recovery Planning Questions

- What is the acceptable duration of outage for each service?
- What data loss, if any, is acceptable?
- Which dependencies can create a hidden single point of failure?
- Who has authority to declare a continuity event and change priorities?
- How will staff communicate if normal email, VoIP, or district systems are unavailable?

- When were backups and restoration procedures last tested?

Leadership Action

The CTO should validate this matrix annually with business owners. Changes in vendors, cloud services, identity systems, network architecture, or district processes may change dependencies and recovery order.

Reference Points

- [CoSN IT Management Resources](#) - K-12 technology operations and leadership resources.
- [USAC E-Rate Program](#) - Federal E-Rate program information for schools and libraries.
- [SETDA Infrastructure for the Future](#) - Guidance for future-ready broadband and infrastructure planning.
- [Future Ready Schools Frameworks](#) - Systems-oriented planning connecting infrastructure, learning, leadership, budget, and equity.

Leadership use: This document is designed to support district-level review, discussion, and decision-making. Technical validation, procurement review, legal review, or compliance review should be completed by the appropriate district specialists when applicable.